

- m Don't forget about your favourite artists—they may give out samples on their own sites. This depends on the artist, of course, but many acts find MP3s to be great promotional tools. They want you to take it, so go get it!
- m RealOne by Real is an all-in-one media player. It includes powerful ripping software along with great file management. Many players have plug-ins that allow you to use RealOne to transfer tracks to your player; it can burn tracks to CD, too. The paid version (\$10 a month) adds faster encoding and burning, plus a subscription download service.
- m MusicMatch Jukebox is an MP3 jukebox application. It can rip, burn CDs, manage files, and more. The paid version improves ripping and burning speed for a one-time fee of \$20.
- m Nullsoft's Winamp is a simple free player. It supports many formats and is great for making playlists. It won't let you burn CDs, though.
- m MoodLogic edits the ID3 tags of your digital audio files, adding details like year and mood for \$30. It really helps you sort your collection.
- m Dr.Tag helps you edit your file's ID3 tags with a minimum of fuss. The "automatic" button uses the file name to guess the artist, track, and album information.

8.4 Windows Media Player 10

- m **Rip CDs Automatically:** Automatically rip CDs with Windows Media Player 10 just by placing them in the drive.

Windows Media Player 10 can be configured to automatically rip CDs (copy the contents to your hard drive using a compression format) whenever they are inserted into your computer's CD-ROM drive. Plus, to make things even easier, Media Player can also eject CDs as soon as the ripping is complete, allowing you to more quickly convert your music collection to digital.